

Proposal for Emoji: White Blood Cell

Submitters: Shuhan He, MD; David Rhew, MD (Global Chief Medical Officer and Vice President of Healthcare, Microsoft); Heena Purohit (Director, AI Startups, Microsoft)

Main point of contact: Shuhan He

Date: 2026-07-27

1. Identification

Keywords: immunity; defense; infection; health; leukocyte

Category: People & Body body-parts

2. Images

	18x18	72x72
Colour		
Black and white		

The image uses the standard [neutrophil form](#) as the visual model for the broader white-blood-cell category. The pale folded membrane first establishes one cell, while the single connected segmented nucleus supplies the characteristic white-blood-cell cue. These features remain legible at actual keyboard size and separate the image from a spiked microbe, a teardrop-shaped Drop of Blood, and a generic cell diagram with a round center.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original Medical Emoji artwork, that I own or control all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, text, digit, or barcode. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

[CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication](#)

3. Factors for inclusion

a. Multiple meanings

Beyond the cell itself, White Blood Cell carries the ordinary sense of a defense that works from the inside. Everyday speech already uses the immune system this way: someone says their defenses are down, that they are fighting something off, or that they are building up resistance, and none of those sentences is about a particular cell. In a message the image can carry that sense as well, standing for holding up under strain, recovering strength, or resisting something that is wearing a person down.

This symbolic reading is secondary. The primary meaning stays the literal white blood cell and the white-cell count.

b. Use in sequences

White Blood Cell can combine with existing emoji to express messages about the body's defenses:

- White Blood Cell + Microbe: the body fighting or responding to an infection.
- White Blood Cell + Shield: the immune system or the body's defenses.
- White Blood Cell + down arrow or up arrow: a low, high, or recovering white-cell count.

c. Breaks new ground

Yes. The current Unicode emoji vocabulary can show a germ with Microbe, blood as a fluid with Drop of Blood, and a laboratory activity with Test Tube, but it cannot show the body's defense cell. White Blood Cell adds the positive counterpart to Microbe: the body responding to the germ. It lets users express the immune system itself, the body fighting infection, or a white-cell count without substituting the threat for the response.

[Current Unicode Emoji List](#)

d. Distinctiveness

At 18 pixels, the enclosing pale membrane first establishes one cell. Inside it, a single connected, asymmetric three-lobed nucleus supplies the white-blood-cell cue and distinguishes the image from a generic cell's round center. The folded outline has neither Microbe's spiked edge nor Drop of Blood's teardrop point. These cues remain clear in colour and black and white. Vendors may vary the outline, lobe count, colour, and shading while preserving the enclosing pale cell body and single connected lobed center.

The design uses neutrophil morphology because neutrophils are the most numerous circulating white blood cells; the name and intended meaning remain the broad White Blood Cell category.

The figure below shows the proposed image beside a generic cell diagram, in colour and in black and white, at actual keyboard size and enlarged. The generic cell is the harder comparison to win, because Microbe's spikes and Drop of Blood's teardrop are already distinct silhouettes while a plain cell shares the proposed outline. At 18 pixels the two separate on the interior: the proposal resolves into an off-centre, connected, multi-part nucleus, and the control resolves into a single round dot.

White Blood Cell: recognition at keyboard size

The proposed image and a generic cell control, shown at actual size and enlarged.

Concept	Rendering	18x18 actual	18x18 at 8x	72x72 actual	Notes
White Blood Cell	Colour				Proposed image: one connected, asymmetric three-lobed nucleus inside a folded pale membrane
Generic cell diagram	Colour				Control: one round nucleus inside a plain circular outline
White Blood Cell	Black and white				Proposed image: one connected, asymmetric three-lobed nucleus inside a folded pale membrane
Generic cell diagram	Black and white				Control: one round nucleus inside a plain circular outline

All artwork in this figure is original to this proposal. Figure date: 2026-07-27.

NCBI Bookshelf: Histology, White Blood Cell

All artwork displayed in this proposal as proposed emoji artwork is the original work identified in Section 2. Every mark in the figure above, including the generic cell control, is original to this proposal. No third-party emoji artwork appears anywhere in this document.

e. Usage level

The clearest everyday meaning is the body's defense cell. White Blood Cell can express messages such as "my body is fighting an infection," "my immune defenses are low," or "my white-cell count is recovering." It also lets people discuss immunity without using Microbe, which represents the germ rather than the body's response.

These messages apply to personal health updates, conversations about getting sick or recovering, and plain explanations of how the immune system works. Biology education and research are secondary uses.

The five required sources are set out in Section 6 and they do not all point the same way. On Google Search the term returns a larger result inventory than `elephant`, about 880,000,000 against about 491,000,000. On Google Video Search it returns about one sixth of `elephant`. On Google Trends the indexed interest is well below `elephant` in both Web Search and Image Search, and in Google Books the 2022 frequency is about a tenth. Taken together they show a term with a very large indexed web presence, a durable and rising published record, and a modest share of the query volume that a common animal noun attracts.

White blood cells [help the body fight infection](#), and [white-cell counts](#) are routinely used to monitor health. Search and Video figures below are indexed-result estimates, not counts of individual users or direct measures of emoji demand.

f. Completeness

Not applicable.

g. Compatibility

Not applicable.

4. Counterarguments to factors for exclusion

a. Already represented

No. Microbe represents the germ, and Drop of Blood represents blood as a fluid. In a message such as "my white-cell count is recovering," Microbe would name the germ rather than the immune cell being measured. Adding Shield or laboratory emoji still cannot supply that missing subject.

b. Overly specific

White Blood Cell is the broad leukocyte category, not a particular subtype, disease, procedure, specialty, treatment, or campaign. Routine white blood counts group five major cell types under this umbrella term. The artwork uses one representative form for legibility, while the character name and intended meaning remain White Blood Cell.

c. Open-ended

Red Blood Cell, Platelet, a generic Cell, and individual leukocyte subtypes are the most likely follow-on candidates. White Blood Cell has a specific boundary: it is the upper-level concept for the body's defense cells, the host-cell counterpart to Microbe, and the familiar umbrella term used when discussing immunity and white-cell counts. Individual leukocyte types are narrower members of this proposed category, while a generic Cell would not convey immune defense or a white-cell count. Red Blood Cell and Platelet would present different semantic and substitute questions and are not implied by this proposal. Selection of White Blood Cell therefore stops at the broad leukocyte category rather than beginning a series of blood components or human cells.

d. Transient

White blood cells are a durable biological and everyday health concept. The Google Books record below extends through 2022 and shows increasing modern published use, while the current Search and Trends evidence documents ongoing use across web, image, and video formats.

e. Faulty comparison

The `elephant` comparisons measure relative frequency only; they do not claim that another emoji creates a precedent. White Blood Cell addresses the specific gap between the body's immune cell and the Microbe it responds to.

5. Other information

The notes in this section are design suggestions offered to vendors. This proposal does not request an exact image. At 18x18, fine microscopic detail should yield to legibility. We suggest keeping a visible band of pale cytoplasm around the nucleus so that the enclosing membrane and the segmented center remain separate cues. We suggest avoiding radiating spikes, which imply Microbe, and keeping the nucleus a single connected feature rather than a face-like arrangement. We suggest the character name remain White Blood Cell rather than a leukocyte subtype.

Prior submission

A White Blood Cell proposal appears as declined, with a 2020 date, on Unicode's published [emoji proposal status list](#). The re-submission period described on that page has elapsed. The present document is an independent proposal. It does not revise, extend, or rely on the earlier submission, and it should be assessed on the case set out above.

6. Evidence of frequency

All data are from July 2026 and were obtained in a Firefox Private Browsing window. Search queries disable personalized results. Trends use Worldwide, all categories, and the full available period. Books uses the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3.

Google prints its result totals as estimates, and a single page load will occasionally return a figure orders of magnitude away from the one the same query returns on reload. The Search and Video captures below were therefore each loaded three times, and the figure reported here is one that held across all three loads.

Google Search

Captured 2026-07-27 using the required grouped term `white-blood-cell`. The result page reports about 880,000,000 results, compared with about 491,000,000 for `elephant` under the same settings.

Open the reproducible Google Search query

Google

white-blood-cell

X

🔊

🔄

🔍

⚙️

🔗

📱

Sign in

All

Images

Videos

Shopping

Forums

Short videos

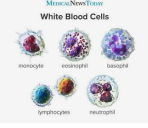
More

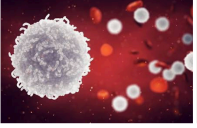
Tools

AI Overview

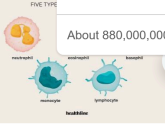
Microscopic

White Blood Cells





FIVE TYPES



A white blood cell, also called a leukocyte, is **a key part of the body's immune system that helps fight infections, bacteria, and viruses**. The five main types are neutrophils, lymphocytes, and monocytes. [MedlinePlus \(.gov\) +1](#)

Types and Functions

Show more

6 sites

Definition of white blood cell - NCI Dictionary of Cancer Terms

A type of blood cell that is made in the bone marrow and found in the blood and lymph...

National Cancer Institute (.gov)

White Blood Cells: Types, Function & Normal Ranges

There are five types of white blood cells: *
Basophils Produce an allergic respons...

Cleveland Clinic

Cleveland Clinic

<https://my.clevelandclinic.org/health/body/21871...>

White Blood Cells: Types, Function & Normal Ranges

Jul 23, 2021 — White blood cells are a part of your immune system that protects your body from infection. These cells circulate through your bloodstream and tissues.



People also ask

What happens if white blood cells are high?

What happens if white blood cells are low?

How can I increase my white blood cells?

What disease affects white blood cells?

National Cancer Institute (.gov)

7 of 14

Google

elephant

✕ 🔊 🔄 🔍

⚙️ 🔗 📱

Sign in

All

Images

Shopping

Videos

Short videos

News

More ▾

Tools ▾

See results about



Elephants

Animal

Any time ▾

All results ▾

Advanced Search

About 491,000,000 results (0.48s)



Elephant

Animal ⓘ



Source: Britannica





The Nature Conservancy

Animals We Protect: African Bush Elephant

The African bush elephant is the largest land mammal in the world and the largest...

Oct 27, 2025

Gestation... ▾

Asian elephant: 18 – 22 month...

+1

Speed >

African bush elephant: 25 mph

YouTube • Ben G Thomas



Evolution of HANTS

6 days ago

Wikipedia

<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/elephant> ⓘ

Elephant

Elephants are the largest living land animals. Three living species are currently recognised: the African bush elephant (*Loxodonta africana*), the African ...

Videos ⓘ



36:28

10 Extraordinary Elephant Moments

YouTube • BBC Earth ⓘ

3 weeks ago



11:22

The Elephant Herd Loving the First Spring Rains

YouTube • HERD Elephant Orphanage South Africa ⓘ

Nov 3, 2025

Overview

Elephants are the largest living land animals. Three living species are currently recognised: the African bush elephant, the African forest elephant, and the Asian elephant. They are the only surviving members of the family Elephantidae and the order Proboscidea; extinct relatives include mammoths and mastodons. [Wikipedia](#)

Gestation period	Asian elephant: 18 – 22 months, African bush elephant: 22 months
Speed	African bush elephant: 25 mph
Lifespan	Asian elephant: 48 years, African bush elephant: 60 – 70 years, African forest elephant: 60

Google Video Search

Captured 2026-07-27 using the required grouped term `white-blood-cell`. The video result page reports about 13,900,000 results, compared with about 84,700,000 for `elephant` under the same settings.

Open the reproducible Google Video Search query

Google white-blood-cell X Voice Search Settings Sign in

All Images **Videos** News Shopping Forums More Tools

www.youtube.com › watch
What Are White Blood Cells | Health | Biology | F
Blood consists of red blood cells, white blood cells are our warriors; the army in
YouTube · FuseSchool - Global Education · Oct 1, 2023
5 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch
What are white blood cells? #AML
Watch the full course and our most up-to-date content here: <https://linktr.ee/HealthTreeUniversity> Create a free account to track your ...
YouTube · HealthTree Foundation for Leukemia · Aug 14, 2023
9 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch
White Blood Cells: The 5 WBC Types, Reference Ranges ...
Get a free NCLEX sample test today: <http://lectur.io/nclexmsampletestyt> =
Create your free account today: <http://lectur.io/nurseeregistryt> ...
YouTube · Lecturio Nursing · Jan 7, 2024
10 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch
White Blood Cells | Leucocytes
White blood cells, also called leukocytes or leucocytes, are cells of the immune system that are involved in protecting the body against ...
YouTube · Hussain Biology · Jul 29, 2023
3 key moments in this video

www.youtube.com › watch
Discover the DIFFERENT TYPES OF WHITE BLOOD CELLS

Any duration
Any time
Any quality
All videos
Any source
Advanced Search
About 13,900,000 results (0.13s)

Google

elephant

✕

🔊

🔄

🔍

⚙️

📱

Sign in

All

Images

Videos

News

Shopping

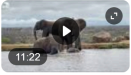
Forums

More

Tools

www.youtube.com › watch

The Elephant Herd Loving the First Spring Rains

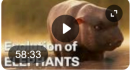


11:22

Carer Owen captures a peaceful morning with the elephants as they enjoy a chilly morning swim. The air is still cool and the sun is just starting to rise. YouTube · HERD Elephant Orphanage South Africa · 6 days ago

www.youtube.com › watch

The Truth of Elephant Evolution

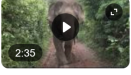


58:33

Elephants, the largest animals to walk on land today, are fascinating creatures. These great, intelligent beasts, with massive specialised brains, have evolved over millions of years. YouTube · Ben G Thomas · 6 days ago

www.youtube.com › watch

Rescued Elephant Kham Suk Reunited With Her Sister ...



2:35

elephantrescue #kamsuk #reunion Kham Suk is a former logging elephant from Laos. During her years in the logging industry, she gave birth to several calves. YouTube · elephantnews · 1 day ago

www.youtube.com › watch

Incredible Wild Elephant Encounter with the Jabulani Herd

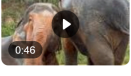


7:51

A young wild bull recently wandered over to join our herd as they grazed peacefully near a muddy patch. His smaller size and frame show that he is a young bull. YouTube · HERD Elephant Orphanage South Africa · Sep 2, 2025

www.instagram.com › reel › DbQjedfzJU

Following Giants on Instagram: "Watching any elephant play ..."



0:46

No one understands an elephant better than another elephant. Most rescued elephants carry deep physical and emotional scars. No medicine can heal them. Instagram · Following Giants · 5 hours ago

www.youtube.com › watch

Any duration

Any time

Any quality

All videos

Any source

Advanced Search

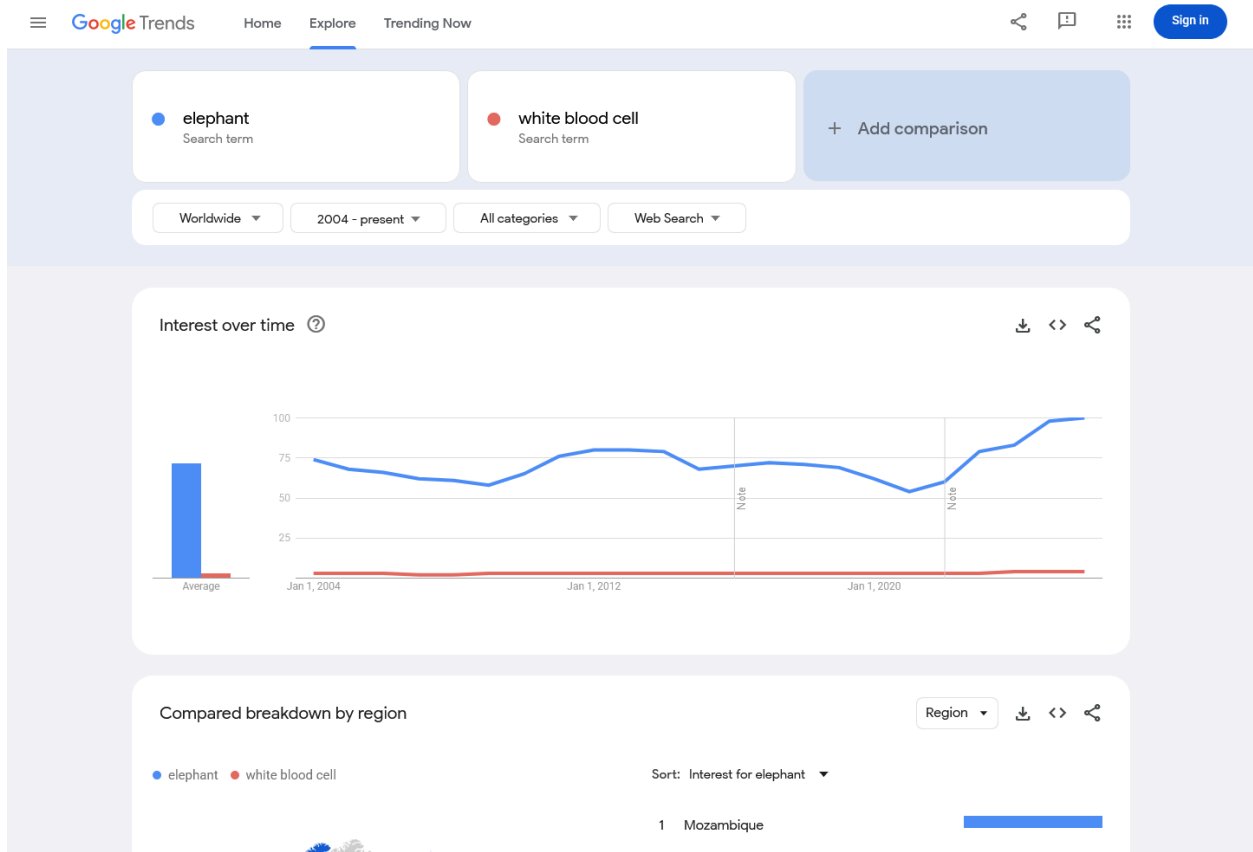
About 84,700,000 results (0.15s)

11 of 14

Google Trends - Web Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2004-present, all categories, and Web Search. Average indexed interest was 72 for elephant and 3 for white blood cell ; the white-blood-cell series reaches 4 in 2024, 2025, and 2026.

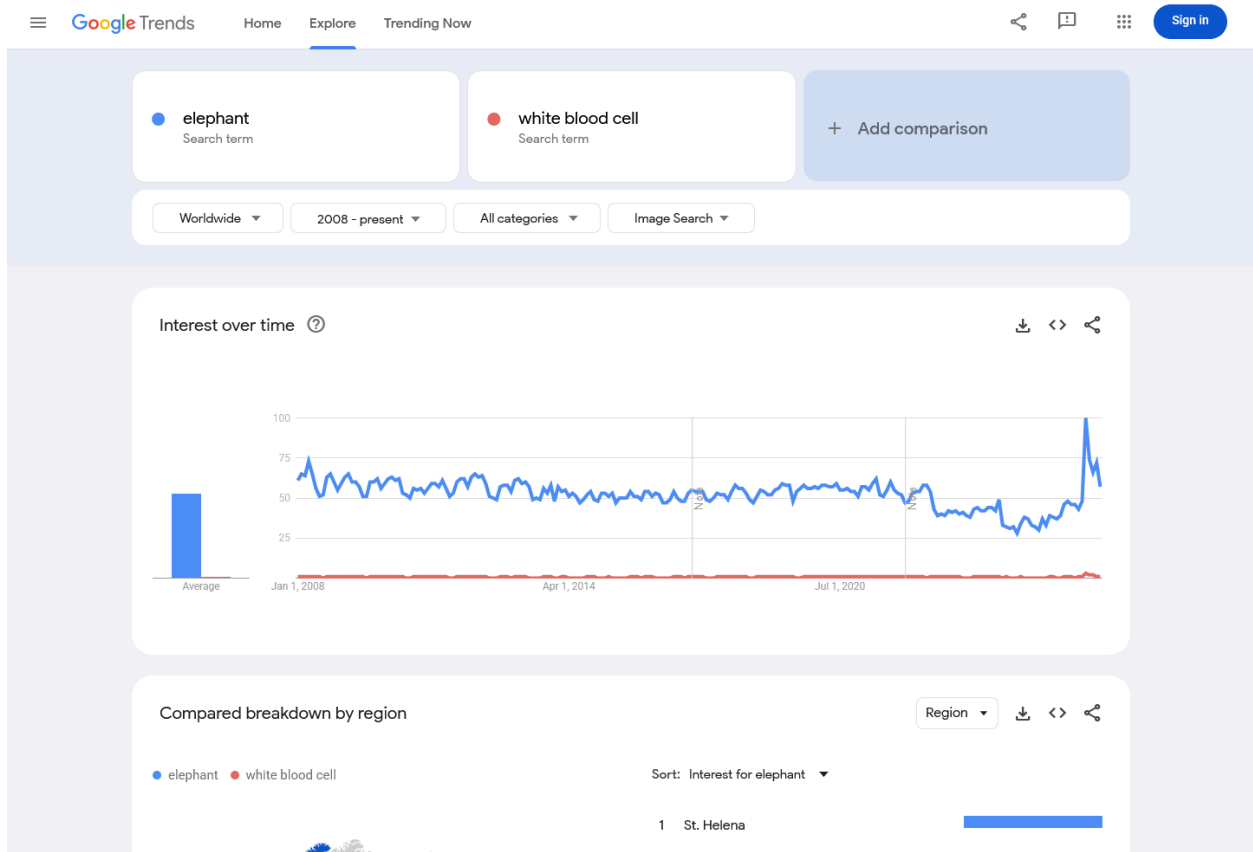
[Open the Google Trends Web Search comparison](#)



Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-07-26 using Worldwide, 2008-present, all categories, and Image Search. Average indexed interest was 53 for **elephant** and 1 for **white blood cell**, with recurring white-blood-cell interest across the period.

[Open the Google Trends Image Search comparison](#)



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-26 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. In 2022, the frequency of `white blood cell` was approximately 10.13% of `eLephant` , with an increasing modern series.

[Open the Google Books Ngram comparison](#)

